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Nicholas Fucci

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics (expected) <i>University of California, Irvine</i>	2022 - 2028
Master of Arts in Economics <i>University of California, Irvine</i>	2022 - 2023
Bachelor of Arts in Economics <i>Emmanuel College, Boston</i> Magna Cum Laude Academic Distinction in Economics Sigma Beta Delta Excellence at Emmanuel Award	2013 - 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields of specialization: Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Public Economics.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Working Papers

"Vacancies After Visa Determinations: Evidence From Online Job Postings and H-1B Lotteries." (sole author)

This paper studies how firms adjust labor demand in response to realizations of the H-1B visa lottery. I construct firm-level measures of lottery success using administrative H-1B data and link these measures to detailed online job posting data from Lightcast and workforce data from LinkedIn. I find that firms with more favorable lottery outcomes increase vacancy postings in the quarters following the lottery. The vacancy response is strongest for remote and hybrid postings and for mid-level positions, while also increasing across levels of education. I also find increases in overall headcount as proxied for by LinkedIn profile experiences. Finally, I provide evidence that firms operate in a repeated-lottery environment, where annual lotteries are predictable and firms may optimize over multiple lottery cycles. Specifically, firms with relatively more success in prior lotteries that go on to participate in future lotteries demonstrate higher rates of of vacancy postings.

"Industrial Robots and Union Representation: Implications for Labor Market Outcomes." (sole author)

I investigate the differential impact of exposure to industrial robots on the earnings of union and non-union workers over the 40-year period from 1983-2022. To estimate this effect, I develop a measure of exposure to industrial robot technology using a natural language processing (NLP) technique. Specifically, I apply a dependency parsing algorithm to text from occupation taxonomies and U.S. patents to quantify the relevance of robot-related innovations to each occupation. The results show that union members working in occupations exposed to industrial robots experience a significant earnings premium relative to non-union members in the same occupation. In my preferred specification, the results indicate a one standard deviation increase in exposure to industrial robot technology is associated with 2.6% higher weekly earnings for union workers.

Works In Progress

"The Effects of AI Adoption on Firms" (with David Neumark)

"High Skilled Immigrants and Trade" (with William Lincoln)

CONSULTING EXPERIENCE

Burning Glass Institute, Remote

2025 - Present

PART-TIME ECONOMIST

The Burning Glass Institute advances data-driven research and practice on the future of work and of workers, partnering with educators, employers, and policymakers to develop solutions that build economic mobility and opportunity through skills.

Collective Intelligence, Remote

2021 - 2022

RESEARCH SUPPORT CONSULTANT

Collective Intelligence is a consulting firm dedicated to creating collaborative techniques to help communities and socially conscious organizations create breakthrough ideas. My position was contractual and remote.

Competition Dynamics, Salem, Massachusetts

2017 - 2021

SENIOR ECONOMIC ANALYST

Competition Dynamics is an economic consulting firm that analyzes, solves, and testifies about economic problems at the intersection of antitrust, intellectual property, and international trade. I was promoted from Economic Analyst to Senior Economic Analyst in July, 2020.

ACADEMIC RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

University of California, Irvine, Irvine, CA

RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO MATTHEW FREEDMAN & DAVID NEUMARK

March, 2026 - Present

- Assist in a study evaluating the impact of Opportunity Zones on local businesses.
- Data: restricted Census data.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO MARION AOUAD

April, 2025 - September, 2025

- Assist in a study examining the financial effects of death on surviving family members.
- Data: California Consumer Credit Panel and the California Comprehensive Master Death file.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DAMON CLARK

Summer 2024

- Assist in a large scale study evaluating the impact of grade retention policies using a Regression Discontinuity design.
- Data: state administrative school records.

CONFERENCES

- **2026:** LERA@ASSA.

SKILLS AND QUALIFICATIONS

Programming	Python, SAS, SQL, Stata, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Matlab, Microsoft Office Suite
Languages	English (native), Spanish (Level B2 upper Intermediate)
Certificate	Python Programming (awarded by General Assembly)
Data Authorizations	Census Special Sworn Status

COURSEWORK

Labor Economics, Applied Methods for Applied Microeconomics, Macro-Labor & Economic Geography, Panel Data, Public Economics, Political Economy.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Irvine,

2022 - Present

TEACHING ASSISTANT

- Basic Economics II - Principles of Macroeconomics (3)
- Economics of the Environment (1)
- Labor Economics & Human Resources (1)
- Intermediate Macroeconomics (1)
- Intermediate Microeconomics (4)